foils **User Manual**

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foils is a minimal FoilTeX-inspired LaTeX slide class. It is implemented as `foils.cls`, loads the standard `article` class, and adds a small set of commands for writing landscape slide decks with large Computer Modern fonts.

This document describes the public interface provided by the class file `foils.cls`.

1 Overview

foils is intended for simple lecture or seminar slide decks. The class sets up letter-sized landscape pages by default, a large sans-serif default text face, ragged-right paragraphs, slide-friendly list spacing, and a footer that can show the current section and page number.

A typical deck uses the following structure:

- `\maketitle` creates the title page.
- `\makesection` creates a numbered section page.
- `\makefoil` creates each content foil.
- `\makeappendix` switches to appendix numbering.
- `\makereference` creates a bibliography page.

2 Installation

For a single talk, copy `foils.cls` next to your main `.tex` file:

```
my-talk/
  talk.tex
  foils.cls
```

Then select the class in the usual way:

```
\documentclass{foils}
```

For regular use, install `foils.cls` in a directory searched by your TeX distribution, such as a local `texmf` tree. After installation, refresh your TeX filename database if your distribution requires it.

3 Quick start

The following complete deck `talk.tex` uses the main foils commands:

```
\documentclass{foils}

\title{A Short Talk}
\author{Firstname Lastname}
\date{\today}
\info{Example Slides}

\begin{document}
\maketitle

\makesection{First section}
\begin{itemize}
  \item First topic
  \item Second topic
\end{itemize}

\makefoil{A first foil}
\begin{itemize}
  \item The Foils class uses large slide-friendly type.
  \item Each foil starts on a new landscape page.
  \item Footers show the current section and page number.
\end{itemize}

\makefoil{A second foil}
\[
  E = mc^2
\]

\makeappendix

\makefoil{Backup material}
Appendix foils are numbered A1, A2, and so on.
\end{document}
```

Compile the deck `talk.tex` with a standard LaTeX engine:

```
pdflatex talk.tex
```

4 Class options

foils defines the following class options:

`169` Use 16:9 slides with a page width of 16 inches and a height of 9 inches. Margins, typography, and other settings stay the same. Without this option, pages remain 11 by 8.5 inches.

`lecture` Reset page numbering at each section and print foil numbers as `section-page`, for example '`2-3`'. Without this option, normal page numbering is used. Appendix foils use `A1`, `A2`, and so on in both modes.

Use the option like this:

```
\documentclass[lecture]{foils}
```

For widescreen slides, use `\documentclass[169]{foils}`. The options can be combined as `\documentclass[169,lecture]{foils}`.

5 Command reference

`\info{text}` Store metadata shown in small type on section title pages. Typical values include a course name, seminar name, or event label.

`\maketitle` Create the title page using LaTeX's standard `\title`, `\author`, and `\date` values. The title page is numbered internally as page `0`, so it does not print a normal footer. The article-style `\thanks` command is not supported on title pages.

`\makesection{title}` Start a new numbered section on a new page. The section title is remembered for later foil footers. In `lecture` mode, the page counter is reset to `1`. The command advances LaTeX's standard `section` counter, so manual adjustments can use `\setcounter{section}{number}`.

`\makefoil{title}` Start a content foil on a new page with a centered title. The footer prints the current section title on the left and the page number on the right.

`\makeappendix` Start the appendix. foils inserts an appendix title page, clears the normal section footer, and numbers later appendix foils as `A1`, `A2`, and so on.

`\makereference[fontsize]{bibfile}` Start a bibliography page using the `alpha` bibliography style. The optional `fontsize` argument defaults to `\small`; pass another declaration such as `\footnotesize` if the reference list is long. Use this command instead of calling `\bibliography` directly.

`\vf` Insert stretchable vertical space using `\vspace*{\fill}`. This is useful for pushing material toward the bottom of a foil.

Inherited article commands that do not match the foil model report class errors:

`\section`, `\subsection`, `\subsubsection`, `\paragraph`, `\subparagraph`, `\part`, `\appendix`, `\tableofcontents`, `\listoffigures`, and `\listoftables`.

The article-style `abstract`, `titlepage`, and `theindex` environments are disabled too. Use `\makesection`, `\makefoil`, and `\makeappendix` instead.

6 Layout and typography

By default, foils configures the page as landscape letter paper, with an 11 inch width and an 8.5 inch height. The `169` option changes these dimensions to 16 inches by 9 inches while keeping the same margins and typography. It sets the PDF page size to the same dimensions.

The default family is sans serif. Normal body text is set at a large slide-oriented size, with larger display sizes available through the standard `\large`, `\Large`, `\LARGE`, `\huge`, and `\Huge` declarations. Paragraphs are ragged right with no indentation, and lists use wider label spacing suitable for projected slides.

The class loads `fix-cm`, `enumitem`, and `graphicx`. You may load additional packages in your document preamble as usual.

7 Appendix and references

Call `\makeappendix` once before backup slides:

```
\makeappendix

\makefoil{Additional Details}
This foil is numbered A1.
```

For bibliographies, create a normal BibTeX file and call `\makereference`:

```
\makereference{refs}
```

This reads entries from `refs.bib`. The class selects the `alpha` bibliography style. Use `\makereference` rather than calling `\bibliography` directly.

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